

Boat is searched in blast inquiry

By RICHARD WINTON, HANNAH FRY AND CHRISTOPHER BUCHANAN

The investigation into a deadly explosion that killed three Los Angeles County Sheriff's Department bomb squad technicians at a training facility continued to expand Monday, with authorities executing a search warrant on a boat docked at Marina del Rey.

Witnesses said more than a dozen police cars swarmed the 13900 block of Marquesas Way on Monday morning with officers interviewing boat owners and evacuating people from the dock.

It was not immediately clear by the afternoon whether authorities had found anything on the boat, but investigators said the search was a result of them following leads on the possible origin of grenades found inside a Santa Monica apartment complex storage area last week and transported to East L.A., where the explosion occurred Friday morning.

The blast was the single deadliest incident for the department in more than 150 years, killing department veterans Dets. Joshua Kelley-Eklund, Victor Lemus and William Osborn.

"While the pain of this loss will always be felt, we hope our efforts provide the answers a tragedy like this demands," said Kenneth R. Cooper, special agent in charge of the Bureau of Alcohol [See Inquiry, A8]



JAVIER DIAZ SANTANA, 32, left, is welcomed home in South L.A. after returning from Texas.

Deaf, mute, terrified — and shipped to Texas by ICE

Javier Diaz Santana, a DACA recipient, was arrested in an immigration raid at his car wash job in Temple City

By BRITTNY MEJIA

He was on his way to wash a car when he glanced up and saw co-workers sprinting off. A woman frantically motioned for him to flee. His heart raced as he tried to find the source of their alarm.

Confused and frightened, Javier Diaz Santana jumped over the wall behind the car wash in the San Gabriel Valley. Years earlier, a vehicle had run over Diaz's foot while he worked there, and it was a struggle for him to run. He made it about a block. His foot throbbed with pain.

He saw two white SUVs on the street and realized what was unfold-

ing. His workplace was being raided by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents, like so many other businesses and neighborhoods in Los Angeles over the past week.

Breathless, Diaz stopped. One of the vehicles pulled over, blocking his way. Masked, armed men exited, yelling. He tried to understand. He couldn't see a badge. One had a vest with the letters "HSI" — Homeland Security Investigations, an arm within ICE.

One seemed to be demanding something. Diaz gestured at his ears.

He could not hear. And he couldn't speak.

Diaz, 32, is deaf and mute. He thought that presenting his his Real ID driver's license would keep him safe. He has legal permission to be here. He came to the U.S. from Mexico when he was about 5 years old and had been granted permission to work more than a decade ago under the Obama-era Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals program. He has no criminal history.

He took his wallet from his pocket. An agent grabbed it and wouldn't give it back.

Diaz took out his phone so he could type a message about his disability. They took that too. Then they cuffed his hands and shoved him [See Diaz, A6]

3 Marines' toughest mission: Freeing their dad

By NATHAN SOLIS

Narciso Barranco, an undocumented landscaper in Orange County, instilled a sense of pride for his adopted country in his three American-born sons.

All three boys joined the Marines, which they saw as a sound start for a better life in the United States.

Then, in June, Barranco was grabbed by masked federal immigration agents while working on the job.

His arrest went viral on social media, with some outraged at images of the agents beating Barranco. For the last month, his family waded through the federal immigration system

under the Trump administration. Narciso, 48, was born in Morelos, Mexico, and arrived in the United States more than 30 years ago, where he married a U.S. citizen and raised three sons.

Within hours of his arrest, his eldest son was talking to reporters and pushing for his release. The sons' service in the U.S. military kept a media focus on his case, and thanks to a variety of interviews his eldest son provided, the case remained in the news cycle.

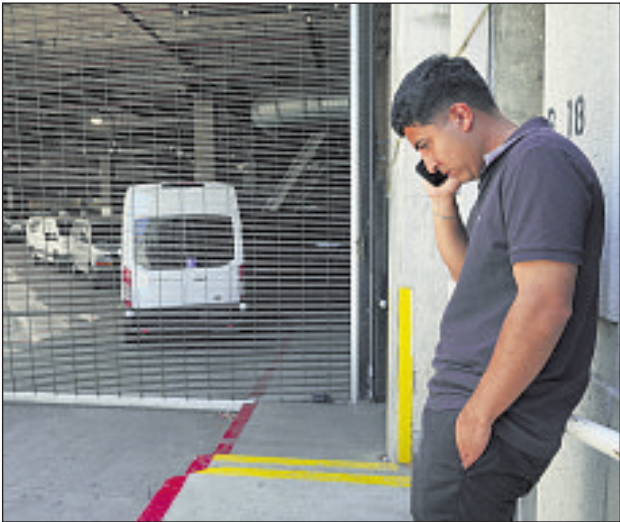
Narciso Barranco was finally released on bond after spending 24 days in custody, but he still faced an uncertain future.

Narciso's best advocate as his case moves forward is

his 25-year-old son Alejandro Barranco, a Marine veteran who served as an engineer equipment mechanic and was deployed to Afghanistan during the U.S. withdrawal from the country.

The junior Barranco has tried his best to rescue his father's livelihood since the arrest. He took up his father's work as a landscaper and put his own work on hold. He's waited outside federal detention facilities — first in Los Angeles and then in Adelanto — just to see his father or to attend immigration court hearings.

"It has for sure been an irritating process, to see how poorly they treat the people [See Sons, A8]



ALEJANDRO BARRANCO outside Metropolitan Detention Center, where his father was held.

MARINES LEAVING AFTER WEEKS IN L.A.

The Pentagon orders the 700 troops to withdraw, claiming credit for 'stability.'

By JULIA WICK

More than a month after President Trump made the fiercely contentious decision to send about 700 U.S. Marines to Los Angeles, those troops will begin withdrawing from the city, Pentagon officials said Monday.

The decision comes a week after the Pentagon announced that half of the almost 4,000 National Guard troops deployed to the Los Angeles area would be released from duty.

The Marines and National Guard were sent to the city in early June amid widespread federal immigration raids and fiery protests against the enforcement actions, with the Trump administration vowing to crack down on "rioters, looters and thugs."

Although the president contended that he had "saved Los Angeles," local and state officials denounced the extraordinary deployment of troops to the streets of an American city.

Advocates and California politicians also argued that the heavy-handed spectacle would be incendiary, potentially putting both the troops and protesters at risk.

The sometimes volatile protests that erupted in downtown Los Angeles and other parts of the region in mid-June have long since wound down.

Some troops are tasked with guarding federal buildings, and some have accompanied immigration agents on tense enforcement actions. In recent days, they have been largely fighting tedium, without much to do.

Speaking on behalf of Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, chief Pentagon spokesperson Sean Parnell credited the troops with helping to bring calm to the area.

"With stability returning to Los Angeles, the Secretary has directed the redeployment of the 700 Marines whose presence sent a clear message: lawlessness will not be tolerated," Parnell said in a statement Monday.

"Their rapid response, unwavering discipline, and unmistakable presence were instrumental in restoring [See Marines, A7]

The wild fight to control S.F. Zoo

Molting peacocks squawked in the distance and a Pacific breeze whispered through the eucalyptus as flamingo keeper Liz Gibbons tidied her station at the San Francisco Zoo.

It had been an unusually cold summer in a city famous for them. Marooned on "a breathtaking piece of land" at the peninsula's far western edge, steps from the deadly surf at Ocean Beach, the timeworn seaside menagerie had endured weeks of gray gloom.

But late that July afternoon, the sun broke through the clouds. Then word began to spread.

"Everybody was like, 'Oh my God, did you hear?'" the keeper recalled. "It's the news we've been waiting for."

For more than a year, the keepers, gardeners, train drivers and office staff of Teamsters Local 856 had been fighting to unseat their boss, longtime San Francisco Zoo Chief Executive Tanya Peterson.

[See Zoo, A14]



A CHILD visits a gorilla at the San Francisco Zoo. A deal to get two pandas from China may be in trouble.

Malcolm-Jamal Warner dies

The "Cosby Show" actor drowned during a family vacation in Costa Rica. He was 54. CALIFORNIA, B4

Dodgers trying to spark Betts

Club moves shortstop to leadoff spot in effort to shake him out of a career-worst season at the plate. SPORTS, B10

Paying homage to East L.A.

New exhibition honors the region's history of art, Latinx identity and political defiance. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Weather

Turning sunny. L.A. Basin: 79/62. B6

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Trump chisels away at Congress' power

GOP lawmakers are continually ceding legislative authority to the president.

By LISA MASCARO

WASHINGTON — "Mr. President, this is the gavel used to enact the 'Big, Beautiful Bill,'" House Speaker Mike Johnson said at a White House signing ceremony on the Fourth of July.

"I want you to have it," he said.

Handing over the gavel delighted President Trump who, seated behind a desk outdoors, immediately tested it out with a few quick thumps.

The moment left a memorable mark on a historic day. The gesture reflected a traditional nod of honor, from one leader to another, a

milestone of the Republican Party's priority legislation becoming law.

But the imagery also underscored a symbolic transfer of political power, from Capitol Hill to the White House as a compliant Congress is ceding more and more of its prerogative to the presidency.

Since Trump's return to the White House in January, and particularly in the last few weeks, Republicans in control of the House and Senate have shown an unusual willingness to give the president of their party what he wants, regardless of the potential risk to themselves, their constituents and Congress.

Republicans raced to put the big package of tax breaks and spending cuts on Trump's desk by his Independence Day deadline. Senators had quickly confirmed almost all of Trump's [See Congress, A14]